Paragate — Narrative Kinematics Report

Generated from manuscript ADT data using the StoryNK model.

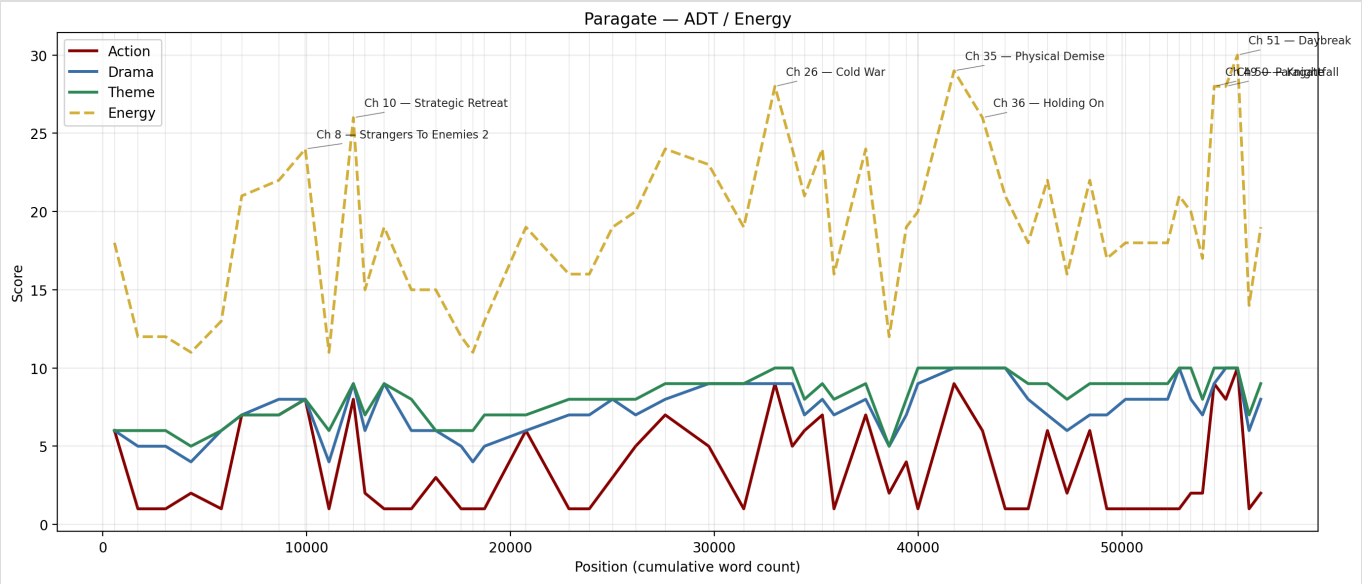
- 01. System Overview
- 02. Top Gravity Peaks
- 03. Top Energy Peaks
- 04. Highest Cut-Risk Elements
- 05. LLM Revision Analysis
- 06. Full Chapter Table

Story Paragate	**Units** 53
Position Span 571 - 56,806	**Mean Energy** 19.17
Mean Gravity 49.11	**Mean Cut Risk** 42.48

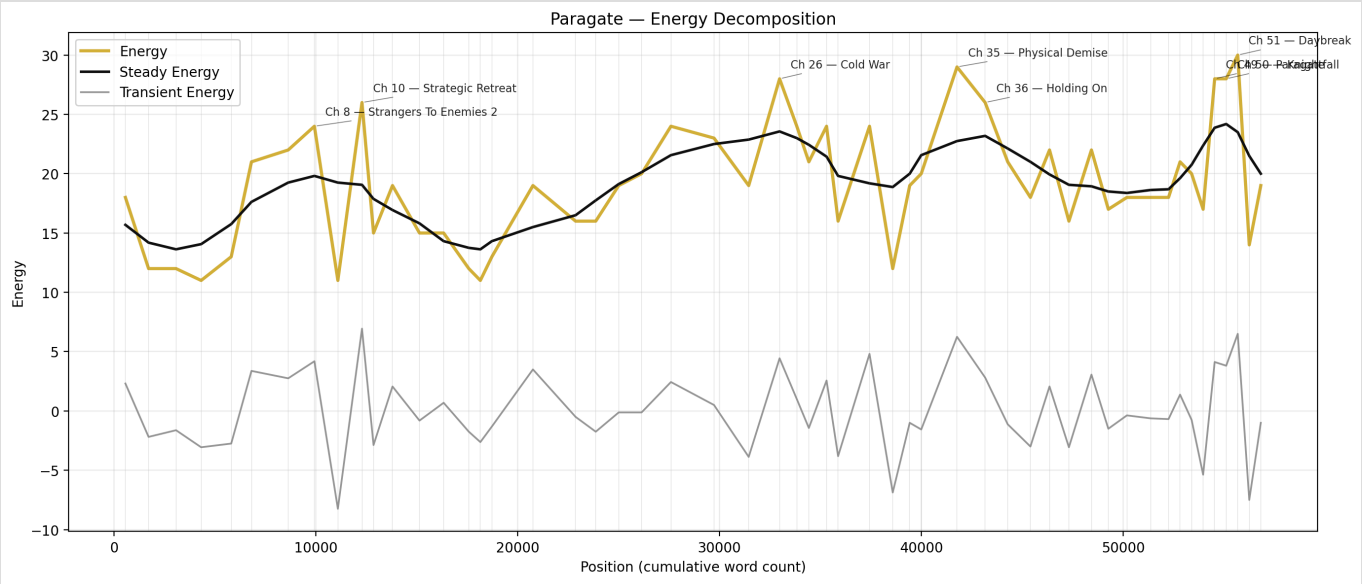
Peak Energy: Ch 51 — Daybreak
Peak Gravity: Ch 50 — Knightfall
Highest Cut Risk: Ch 4 — Secondhand Cottage

System Overview

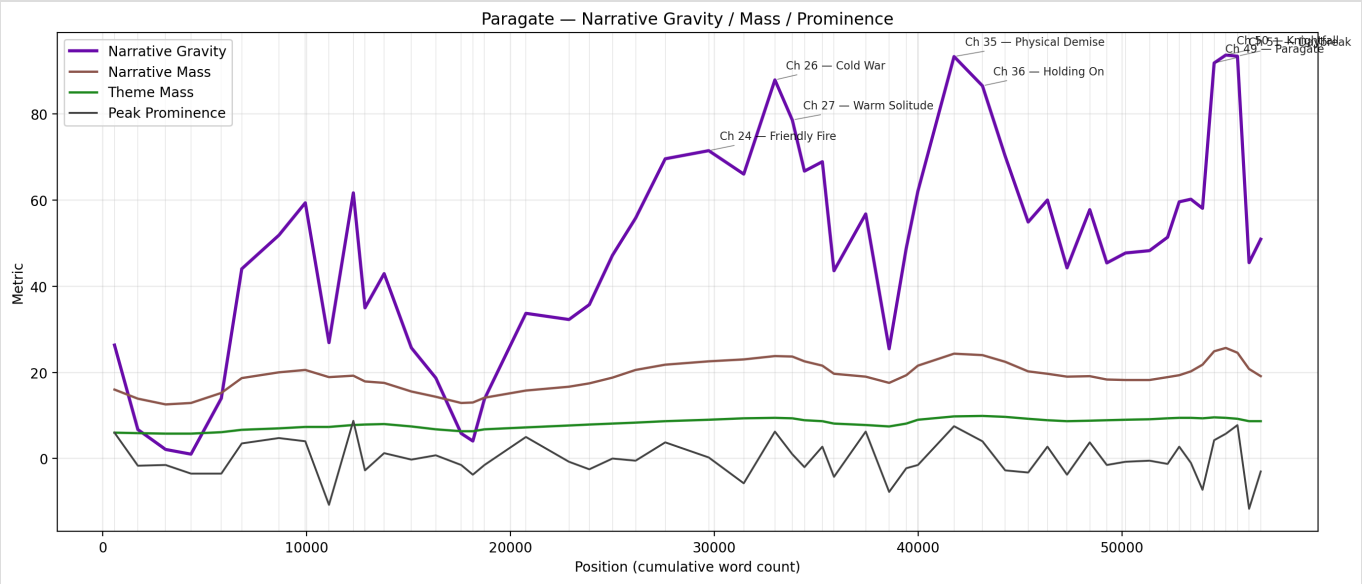
Action, Drama, and Theme define the primary narrative state. Energy is their sum. Steady-state and transient tracks approximate long-wave baseline versus local fluctuation. Narrative Mass, Peak Prominence, and Narrative Gravity estimate which regions are merely loud versus which ones are actually load-bearing.



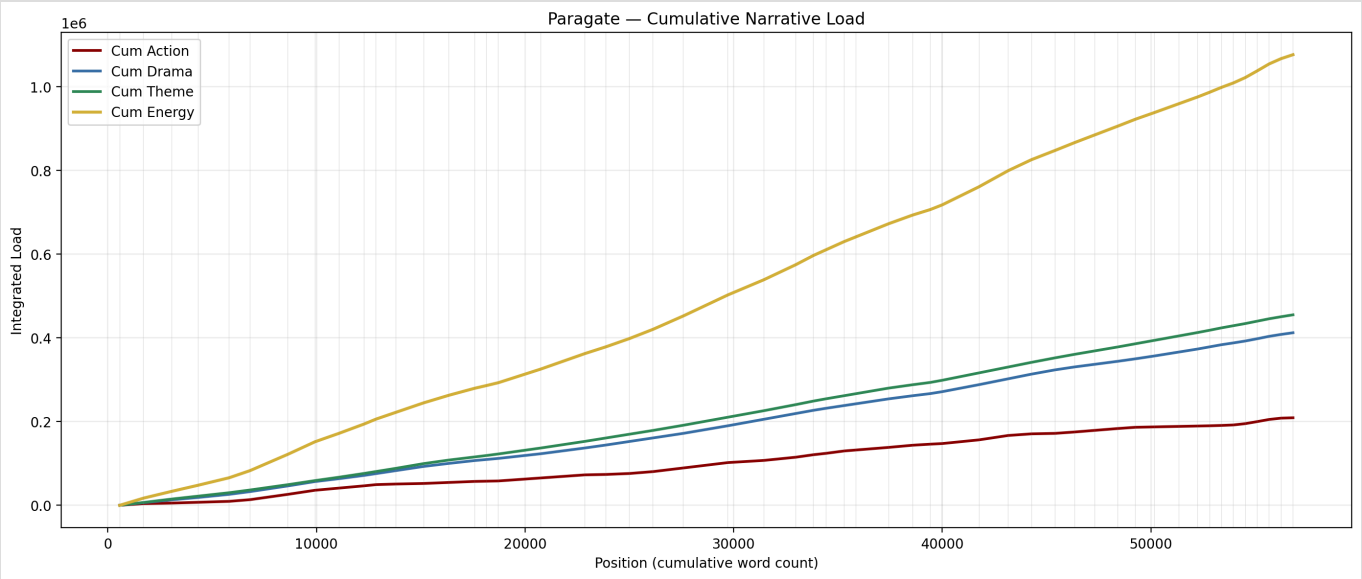
Action, Drama, Theme, and Energy across cumulative story position.



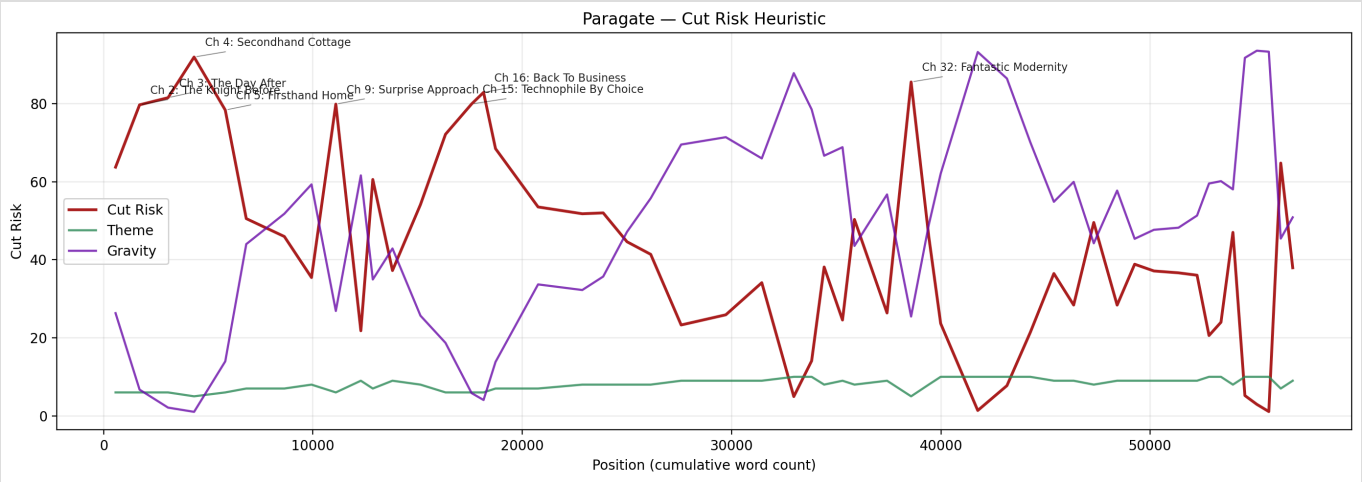
Composite Energy versus steady-state and transient energy behavior.



Narrative Gravity, Mass, Theme Mass, and Peak Prominence.



Cumulative action, drama, theme, and energy load.



Cut-risk heuristic versus theme and gravity.

Top Gravity Peaks

Ch 50 — Knightfall

Gravity: 93.63 | **Energy:** 28.00 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: The battle turns when Cody is the first to notice movement across the frozen lake and realizes the defense is pointed the wrong way. As the first line is held by powers and allies beyond the core cast, the real threat reveals itself as a coordinated strike against the city itself. Katiya is forced into the exact shape of the nightmare that made her who she is, and Cody refuses to leave her to face it entirely alone.

Blurb: Winter arrives with teeth just when the defenses start to hold.

Watching the drone feed, Cody spots enemy figures crossing the lake and realizes the defenses are no longer where they need to be. When comms fail, he leaves the drone idling and r...

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Gravity: 93.37 | **Energy:** 30.00 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: Katiya confronts the living shape of her oldest trauma and proves that what she has learned is stronger than fear. As Nhytyx recreates the emotional architecture of the nightmare that once broke her, Katiya saves her family through action instead of paralysis, while Cody disobeys her only enough to make one small but crucial difference. At dawn, Katiya completes her arc not just by surviving the past, but by replacing it with a new public truth.

Blurb: At the edge of dawn, courage means returning to the exact place fear was born.

Katiya reaches the burning district and finds Nhytyx leading the same kind of horror that defined her childhood trauma: except Endogeny is present (Firebrand). For one terrible bea...

Ch 35 — Physical Demise

Gravity: 93.29 | **Energy:** 29.00 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Guards' Quarter | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: Desperation pulls Katiya beyond the walls, where duty, grief, and old ghosts converge.

It's a new feeling that finds me when I'm rushing through the open streets, one I felt the day before when I heard Cody's voice cheering my name. It's an energy that races my circu...

Ch 49 — Paragate

Gravity: 91.79 | **Energy:** 28.00 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: The true conflict of Paragate begins as witness replaces doubt and preparation replaces denial. Aldrin sees enough to gamble on Katiya, while Cody leaves Navidson-Monroe uncertain of what his honesty has bought him but sure he is not done yet. Both protagonists step fully into the roles they have been resisting, and the story pivots from argument into mobilization.

Blurb: Once the truth is seen with open eyes, the only question left is whether anyone can move fast enough.

Katiya brings Aldrin face-to-face with the reality of the approaching threat, and Jade and Aliaki reinforce what she has forced him to witness. When the Royal Knights arrive, Aldri...

Ch 26 — Cold War

Gravity: 87.86 | **Energy:** 28.00 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified | 2015-10-03

Summary: Jackson's "Operation Bluewings" flashback: drone crash, mission abort, and his sacrificial call to Overwatch in the storm.

Blurb: Years earlier, in a storm of ice and static, a mission hangs by a thread.

It's the cold snap that brings him back again.

Ch 36 — Holding On

Gravity: 86.49 | **Energy:** 26.00 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: Kindness and rediscovery of an old passion dare Cody to care again.

The drawing reads REED because he forgets to use his last name. It was checked by SAKURASHIMA, then approved by PRADESH, and now the chain of custody ends in my greasy hands, putti...

Ch 27 — Warm Solitude

Gravity: 78.56 | **Energy:** 24.00 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Hillfar | The Shortwall | 2005-08-23

Summary: Katiya's origin trauma: childhood game ? treehouse collapse ? Raph's death; she hides in a corpse pit; the Chymaeran lie brands her forever.

Blurb: Long before today, a childhood dare turned into a scar that never closed.

"Why is it so hard for you to let go?" The question comes from thirty feet below.

Ch 24 — Friendly Fire

Gravity: 71.45 | **Energy:** 23.00 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-07-07

Summary: Reed's presentation wins; Cody's mild critique is spun as jealousy and he snaps publicly; Katiya loses to Aryn, is told she's below the line, and learns her family's already in Gaffesend.

Blurb: One wins the crowd; the other loses control. Lines are drawn on both sides.

Reed's entirely prepared as he advances towards his last slide. In the lower corner, it reads 20 OF 20: even with a custom progress bar to show the stages of his presentation.

Top Energy Peaks

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Energy: 30.00 | **Energy:** 30.00 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: Katiya confronts the living shape of her oldest trauma and proves that what she has learned is stronger than fear. As Nhytyx recreates the emotional architecture of the nightmare that once broke her, Katiya saves her family through action instead of paralysis, while Cody disobeys her only enough to make one small but crucial difference. At dawn, Katiya completes her arc not just by surviving the past, but by replacing it with a new public truth.

Blurb: At the edge of dawn, courage means returning to the exact place fear was born.

Katiya reaches the burning district and finds Nhytyx leading the same kind of horror that defined her childhood trauma: except Endogeny is present (Firebrand). For one terrible bea...

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Energy: 29.00 | **Energy:** 29.00 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Guards' Quarter | 2026-11-30

Summary:

Blurb: Desperation pulls Katiya beyond the walls, where duty, grief, and old ghosts converge.

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Blurb: Years earlier, in a storm of ice and static, a mission hangs by a thread.

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Ch 50 — Knightfall

Energy: 28.00 | **Energy:** 28.00 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Unspecified | Unspecified | Unspecified

Summary: The battle turns when Cody is the first to notice movement across the frozen lake and realizes the defense is pointed the wrong way. As the first line is held by powers and allies beyond the core cast, the real threat reveals itself as a coordinated strike against the city itself. Katiya is forced into the exact shape of the nightmare that made her who she is, and Cody refuses to leave her to face it entirely alone.

Blurb: Winter arrives with teeth just when the defenses start to hold.

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Ch 10 — Strategic Retreat

Energy: 26.00 | **Energy:** 26.00 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Katiya's House | 2026-04-25

Summary: Katiya cleans to stave off panic, studies Cody's device; time skip: a month later she hesitates during a royal escort, barely averts disaster, is berated, and runs to find Bertram.

Blurb: A month later, a public moment goes wrong—and Katiya can't shake the blame.

I take deep breaths as I try not to let him break me. Cody's gone now. And I will never have to deal with him again.

Highest Cut-Risk Units

Ch 4 — Secondhand Cottage

CutRisk: 92.00 | **Energy:** 11.00 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Katiya's House | 2026-04-24

Summary: Katiya's trauma baseline: nightmares of Hillfar; she self-stabilizes, starts her day, meets Derry & Carmen (Rayna foreshadow), and heads to base with Bertram.

Blurb: Nightmares, neighbors, and a base run: Katiya fights panic with routine until routine fights back.

The next lucid moment, I find myself pinned upside-down beneath a thick wooden rack. The heat climbs as I drag my heels across the floor, my clothes so black and charred that I pra...

Ch 32 — Fantastic Modernity

CutRisk: 85.60 | **Energy:** 12.00 | **POV:** Katiya, Cody

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-11-29

Summary:

Blurb: Katiya's first peaceful sleep leads straight into chaotic, sword-filled "fantasy" tourism on Earth.

Even in another world, I can't escape the same dream. The only difference is that sleep comes faster on a bed that's made of clouds, instead of one made from horsehair and feathers...

Ch 16 — Back To Business

CutRisk: 82.93 | **Energy:** 11.00 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-05-25

Summary: Cody's spark flickers: nostalgia and lunch with Alan (Jackson talk); he returns hoping for an open door.

Blurb: A lunch with Dad. A memory of a brother. A door that might be open tonight.

"I think that will work just fine," Reed says. "What do you think?"

Ch 3 — The Day After

CutRisk: 81.57 | **Energy:** 12.00 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Shaleborough | Navidson-Monroe Aerospace | 2026-04-24

Summary: Cody's bleak office day: roasted for late redlines, awkward beat with Kei, then family unpacking with Miguel queued up for drinks.

Blurb: Another soul-numbing office day pushes Cody toward a choice he's not ready to make.

I realize I'm done working on the redline when my hands stop moving. Copying changes from a red-inked engineering drawing to the computer is easy enough to get lost in thought. The...

Ch 15 — Technophile By Choice

CutRisk: 79.96 | **Energy:** 12.00 | **POV:** Cody, Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Katiya's House | 2026-05-24

Summary: Cody runs Katiya's route in Gaffesend; she tours him as "royal inventor"; awkward Jullian moment; tavern hang where Cody fits in.

Blurb: Cody tours Katiya's world—and fits in a little too well.

"Have you tried an Eglich?" She asks.

Ch 9 — Surprise Approach

CutRisk: 79.93 | **Energy:** 11.00 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-04-26

Summary: Cody tries to rationalize it away (no wound); barricades the door; nearly late to work; meets foil Reed.

Blurb: Cody barricades more than a door as reality refuses to make sense.

Late Sunday morning, around 11:00, I awoke with my neck twisted against the closet door, my face saturated with drool, shirt missing, and a sticky note taped to my forehead with Mi...

Ch 2 — The Knight Before

CutRisk: 79.74 | **Energy:** 12.00 | **POV:** Katiya

Setting: Valenseia | Gaffesend | Gaffe's End Tavern | 2026-04-23

Summary: Katiya's intro: she struggles to relax, Aldrin frames trainee expectations, and she reconnects with Jullian as they "christen" her new place.

Blurb: Katiya tries to unwind, but duty—and an old flame—won't let her rest.

With every intention to relax, I try to let the peace of this place flood my tense muscles. But I wasn't made for this, and I hate drinking. The only thought on my inebriated mind...

Ch 5 — Firsthand Home

CutRisk: 78.41 | **Energy:** 13.00 | **POV:** Cody

Setting: Colorado | Evergreen Estates | Cody's House | 2026-04-24

Summary: Cody + Miguel bro out, drink hard; Miguel crashes, Cody stays up.

Blurb: Drinks with a best friend turn into confessions—and an idea Cody should ignore.

"Since you started on your first day, you haven't been drug tested. What's gonna change their mind on Monday, bro? My work never runs drug tests," he says. Gunfire cracks over the...

LLM Revision Diagnosis

> **Length assessment:** At 53 short chapters, Paragate is full-length and weighted toward a four-act climax. Overall length is fine; the problem is internal pacing: long, low-energy stretches early and midbook create clear drag corridors that blunt the two-protagonist mirroring gimmick unless trimmed.
> **Structural health:** Structurally strong at the top: the second half — especially chapters 35, 49–51 — supplies clear peaks of action, drama, and thematic payoff. The first third and some midbook scenes sag. Several low-action, high-cut-risk scenes cluster early and in the midbook and threaten momentum.
> **Primary strength:** A tightly built climax cluster (Paragate → Knightfall → Daybreak) that resolves Katiya's arc with high action/drama/theme. The double-protagonist conceit produces powerful mirrored stakes when used to escalate rather than repeat.
> **Primary risk:** Mirror-drag: many mirrored Cody/Katiya beats deliver near-duplicate emotional information rather than additive contrast. Low-energy, high-cut-risk setpieces (dream tourism, domestic replays, procedural domestic days) create long stretches where theme doesn't sufficiently advance the plot.

Keep the major spine and climactic sequence intact — that's where the book sings — but surgically tighten the opening and selected midbook episodes. Eliminate or compress repetitive domestic and ‘tourism’ dream sequences; collapse mirrored scenes unless they show new information or conflicting perspective; protect chapters 49–51 and 35 at all costs. A tight pass focused on merging exposition, pruning fantasy-dream detours, and sharpening the mirrored beats will transform the current slow middle into forward-driving setup for the excellent climax.

Protect at All Costs

- Chapter 49
- Chapter 50
- Chapter 51
- Chapter 35
- Chapter 26
- Chapter 36

Strongest Regions

Ch 49 — Paragate

Reason: Story pivot: both protagonists commit and the narrative pivots from argument into mobilization. High gravity, high theme mass — this is the inciting point for the final act.
Revision instruction: Do not cut. Strengthen immediacy: shorten any reflective asides here so the chapter functions as the trigger that forces immediate action.

Ch 50 — Knightfall

Reason: Peak gravity and setup for emotional climax. High action + drama + theme; converts political stakes into immediate battlefield threat and forces Katiya into the nightmare shape required for arc completion.
Revision instruction: Protect. Ensure scene beats are crisp and causal (Cody's discovery → defensive failure → Katiya's crisis). Trim anything that delays the sequence.

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Reason: Peak energy/action/drama/theme — emotional and thematic payoff for Katiya. It's the story's culmination and the clearest thematic resolution.
Revision instruction: Protect absolutely. Keep sensory immediacy and action economy. If anything feels repetitive of Knightfall, remove it — this must feel like final, non-redundant closure.

Ch 35 — Physical Demise

Reason: High energy and emotional stakes; a structural peak in Act Three that feeds Act Four. Strong thematic mass tied directly to Katiya's arc.
Revision instruction: Keep and, if possible, use as a pacing hinge: make beats here feed Act Four threats so the late-file stakes feel earned rather than dropped into place.

Drag Corridors

Ch 1–12

Problem: slow_opening / repeated orientation | **Confidence:** 0.85

Reason: Many scenes here are low-action, expository, or domestic in similar key (Cody and Katiya intros, repeated door/doorway motifs, multiple small social beats). High collective cut risk and low cumulative gravity slows momentum before the first major escalation.
Suggested fix: Compress the opening two-dozen pages into fewer, higher-stakes scenes: combine redundant domestic beats, move the most necessary worldbuilding into single, sharper encounters, and make the inciting oddity/doorbeat occur earlier and with clearer consequence.

Ch 14–17

Problem: midbook lull / redundant orientation | **Confidence:** 0.78

Reason: This block contains low-action Cody/Katiya orientation and ‘getting-to-know’ beats that repeat earlier information and do little to escalate theme or conflict.
Suggested fix: Trim or merge these chapters; convert small, redundant domestic/comfort beats into micro-scenes embedded in higher-stakes chapters so momentum doesn't stall.

Ch 32–34

Problem: tonal whiplash / fantasy tourism detour | **Confidence:** 0.86

Reason: Chapter 32 (Fantastic Modernity) registers as an energetic and thematic outlier (low action, high cut risk). The 'fantasy tourism' dream sequence interrupts built momentum from the fall arc, creating a pause that doesn't advance threat or character.
Suggested fix: Compress or excise the 'tourism' framing; if any material is essential for theme, fold it into surrounding chapters as a brief memory or single strong image instead of a separate chapter.

Ch 3–6

Problem: high-cut-risk exposition cluster | **Confidence:** 0.80

Reason: Contains multiple low-action, high cut-risk scenes (The Day After, Secondhand Cottage, Firsthand Home) that repeat mood-setting without distinct forward motion.
Suggested fix: Triage: keep what establishes the core inciting facts and character constraints; convert the rest to short beats or delete. Prioritize unique, plot-moving detail over atmospheric repetition.

Cut Candidates

Ch 4 — Secondhand Cottage

Action: compress_hard

Reason: Top raw cut risk (92). Long nightmare/daily routine material that repeats trauma-baseline information already suggested elsewhere.
Target: Reduce dream-length and routine beats to a paragraph or single evocative scene; retain only one explicit trauma-image that will be echoed later.

Ch 32 — Fantastic Modernity

Action: trim

Reason: High cut risk (85.6). 'Fantasy tourism' sequence distracts and duplicates dream imagery without advancing threat or character choice.
Target: Remove tourism framing; keep at most one image or sentence that signals recurring nightmare — fold into adjacent chapter.

Ch 16 — Back To Business

Action: compress_hard

Reason: High cut risk (82.9). Low action; functions as filler nostalgia without moving the plot.
Target: Collapse lunch/nostalgia beats into a single scene that establishes Cody's flicker-of-spark without full detour.

Ch 3 — The Day After

Action: compress_hard

Reason: High cut risk (81.57). Office day/low action; repeats Cody’s discontent without new stakes.
Target: Tighten to essential incident(s) — the minimal scenes that explain Cody’s inertia and introduce Miguel's role; remove ancillary office humdrum.

Ch 15 — Technophile By Choice

Action: merge

Reason: High cut risk (79.96). Duplicate tour-of-world beats that overlap with adjacent chapters.
Target: Fuse with neighboring orientation chapter (14 or 17); remove repeated dialogue and incidental errands.

Ch 9 — Surprise Approach

Action: trim

Reason: High cut risk (79.93). Low-action panic/barricade scene that mostly restates earlier door-confusion beats.
Target: Keep the single high-impact beat (Cody's panic/barricade) and excise repeated interiorization or redundant setup scenes.

Chapter-by-Chapter Notes

Ch 1 — Strangers To Enemies 1

Reason: Keep as the core inciting fun/hook for Cody, but consider shortening the opening paragraphs to accelerate momentum into the door incident.
Note: Keep as the core inciting fun/hook for Cody, but consider shortening the opening paragraphs to accelerate momentum into the door incident.

Ch 2 — The Knight Before

Reason: Katiya’s christening and tavern beat can be compressed; preserve the Aldrin framing line, remove extraneous social padding.
Note: Katiya’s christening and tavern beat can be compressed; preserve the Aldrin framing line, remove extraneous social padding.

Ch 4 — Secondhand Cottage

Reason: High cut risk — compress nightmare and routine. Keep only the scene elements that will be referenced later.
Note: High cut risk — compress nightmare and routine. Keep only the scene elements that will be referenced later.

Ch 10 — Strategic Retreat

Reason: Important for character stakes; keep but trim any reflective tangents that delay the time-skip payoff.
Note: Important for character stakes; keep but trim any reflective tangents that delay the time-skip payoff.

Ch 14 — Luddite By Chance

Reason: Combine small orientation beats into adjacent chapters; avoid long errands that do not advance the plot.
Note: Combine small orientation beats into adjacent chapters; avoid long errands that do not advance the plot.

Ch 16 — Back To Business

Reason: Collapse nostalgia/lunch into a single scene that sparks Cody's tentative arc forward.
Note: Collapse nostalgia/lunch into a single scene that sparks Cody's tentative arc forward.

Ch 26 — Cold War

Reason: Strong flashback with high gravity; it anchors Cody's motivations and must remain intact.
Note: Strong flashback with high gravity; it anchors Cody's motivations and must remain intact.

Ch 32 — Fantastic Modernity

Reason: Tonally jarring — convert to a short interior image or fold into surrounding chapters to avoid interrupting pacing.
Note: Tonally jarring — convert to a short interior image or fold into surrounding chapters to avoid interrupting pacing.

Ch 35 — Physical Demise

Reason: Critical Act Three peak that should be polished for causal links into Act Four.
Note: Critical Act Three peak that should be polished for causal links into Act Four.

Ch 36 — Holding On

Reason: High drama/theme for Cody; keep and ensure it directly informs the choices he makes in Act Four.
Note: High drama/theme for Cody; keep and ensure it directly informs the choices he makes in Act Four.

Ch 49 — Paragate

Reason: The hinge of the final act — preserve, sharpen, and remove anything that softens its pivot function.
Note: The hinge of the final act — preserve, sharpen, and remove anything that softens its pivot function.

Ch 50 — Knightfall

Reason: High-stakes action; sequence timing is everything. Cut indulgent description; keep causal beats tight.
Note: High-stakes action; sequence timing is everything. Cut indulgent description; keep causal beats tight.

Ch 51 — Daybreak

Reason: Final arc resolution: maintain emotional specificity and action economy. Remove repetitions of previous horrors.
Note: Final arc resolution: maintain emotional specificity and action economy. Remove repetitions of previous horrors.

Ch 52 — Parasmagate

Reason: Epilogue — keep but ensure it follows immediately after Daybreak with minimal tonal backtracking.
Note: Epilogue — keep but ensure it follows immediately after Daybreak with minimal tonal backtracking.

Next Revision Pass

- 1) Tighten Act One: collapse or merge low-energy domestic setup scenes (chapters 2–6) so the door/other-world hook and its consequences sit within the first 3–4 chapters.
- 2) Prune or compress dream/tourism material (especially chapter 32 and the long trauma baseline in chapter 4). Convert long dream sequences to single, potent images that echo later rather than interrupting pacing.
- 3) Reduce mirror-drag: audit each Cody/Katiya mirrored pair and keep only the version that adds unique information or true contrast. If both must exist, make them contrapuntal (conflicting perceptions or different consequences) instead of redundant.
- 4) Protect and polish the climax cluster (49–51): tighten causality between Paragate → Knightfall → Daybreak and remove any reflective scenes that duplicate emotional beats already resolved in the action.
- 5) Trim low-theme/high-drama melodrama (overwritten interiority) — convert internal monologues that restate stakes into visible choices and actions.
- 6) Merge small expository chapters into neighboring scenes and ensure every chapter advances either plot (new obstacle) or theme (decision/change), not just atmosphere.
- 7) Re-check POV switching: avoid neutral or indistinct POV frames that dilute emotional immediacy; make each swap earn its space by delivering new stakes, crucial information, or tonal contrast.
- 8) Do a final pass to confirm chapter transitions are driven by conflict, not merely scene change; every chapter should raise a question the next chapter answers or escalates.

Full Chapter / Unit Table

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	E	G	Cut	POV	Summary
1	Strangers To Enemies 1	6.0	6.0	6.0	18.0	26.3	63.8		Cody celebrates his first home, drunkenly stumbles through the adjoining door into another world, is healed by strangers, and fixates on the "cosplayer" girl on the other side.
2	The Knight Before	1.0	5.0	6.0	12.0	6.7	79.7		Katiya's intro: she struggles to relax, Aldrin frames trainee expectations, and she reconnects with Jullian as they "christen" her new place.
3	The Day After	1.0	5.0	6.0	12.0	2.1	81.6		Cody's bleak office day: roasted for late redlines, awkward beat with Kei, then family unpacking with Miguel queued up for drinks.
4	Secondhand Cottage	2.0	4.0	5.0	11.0	1.0	92.0		Katiya's trauma baseline: nightmares of Hillfar; she self-stabilizes, starts her day, meets Derry & Carmen (Rayna foreshadow), and heads to base with Bertram.
5	Firsthand Home	1.0	6.0	6.0	13.0	14.0	78.4		Cody + Miguel bro out, drink hard; Miguel crashes, Cody stays up.
6	Insurgency	7.0	7.0	7.0	21.0	44.0	50.6		Katiya's first day ends in panic when a distant light (Firebrand tie-in) appears; town responds; on returning home she finds an intruder—Cody— and ambushes him.
7	Exfiltration	7.0	8.0	7.0	22.0	51.8	46.0		Prologue re-seen through Katiya: she crosses into the modern world and recoils, landing back through the

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	E	G	Cut	POV	Summary
									door—mirror of Cody's intro.
8	Strangers To Enemies 2	8.0	8.0	8.0	24.0	59.3	35.5		Third clash: Katiya (assuming Auvryan assassin) and Cody fight to another misunderstanding; she drives him back through the door.
9	Surprise Approach	1.0	4.0	6.0	11.0	26.9	79.9		Cody tries to rationalize it away (no wound); barricades the door; nearly late to work; meets foil Reed.
10	Strategic Retreat	8.0	9.0	9.0	26.0	61.6	21.8		Katiya cleans to stave off panic, studies Cody's device; time skip: a month later she hesitates during a royal escort, barely averts disaster, is berated, and runs to find Bertram.
11	Ennui and Excoriation	2.0	6.0	7.0	15.0	35.0	60.6		Another month later: Cody is bored while Reed earns praise; Nav spins up a new project; Cody ghosts social invites, but hears pleading through the door at home.
12	Anxiety and Avoidance	1.0	9.0	9.0	19.0	42.9	37.3		FOUR WEEK TIME SKIPKatiya, Ryder, and Paxton rescue near-dead Bertram; she's blamed and shut out—her only remaining lifeline is Cody.
13	The Sleeping Knight	1.0	6.0	8.0	15.0	25.7	54.2		Katiya crosses mid-panic; Cody calms her and lets her sleep; awkward breakfast; they agree to "no interfering" (both intend to break it).
14	Luddite By Chance	3.0	6.0	6.0	15.0	18.7	72.2		Cody gives her a gentle orientation day: first car ride (terrifying), Costco errand gauntlet—Katiya is overwhelmed by the future.

Ch	Chapter	A	D	T	E	G	Cut	POV	Summary
15	Technophile By Choice	1.0	5.0	6.0	12.0	5.8	80.0		Cody runs Katiya's route in Gaffesend; she tours him as "royal inventor"; awkward Jullian moment; tavern hang where Cody fits in.
16	Back To Business	1.0	4.0	6.0	11.0	4.1	82.9		Cody's spark flickers: nostalgia and lunch with Alan (Jackson talk); he returns hoping for an open door.
17	Onward To Chaos	1.0	5.0	7.0	13.0	13.8	68.5		Katiya visits Bertram in the hospital (promises Hillfar); market duty goes sideways; she chases and collars Rayna (Ahkvasan half-blood); Jullian downplays her leap; Cody leaves a treat.
18	Civillian Combat	6.0	6.0	7.0	19.0	33.7	53.6		Cody's volunteer training day: Katiya teases, his mistake catches Aldrin's eye; later he chooses friendship over victory in a challenge—character beat.
19	Warrior Business	1.0	7.0	8.0	16.0	32.3	51.8		Open house at Cody's work: meet Reed & Kei; Cody geeks out, Katiya meets Alan & Kim; they overhear Reed/Kei on Cody missing from the "Future Talent" wall.
20	Domestic Relations	1.0	7.0	8.0	16.0	35.7	52.0		Katiya engineers a Cody—Kei date; in parallel she and Jullian go to hot springs and bristle; Cody's date feels off and foggy—he insists he's "fine."
21	Foreign Affairs	3.0	8.0	8.0	19.0	47.2	44.6		Katiya extracts an uncomfortable truth from Jullian; intercut meltdown date beats (both couples misfire);

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									Cody & Kei hook up but it lands as empty.
22	Losing To Fear	5.0	7.0	8.0	20.0	55.8	41.4		Katiya passes core exams but shoots poorly; Aryn is unflappable; Cody and Reed clash about what a Level-1 is; Katiya insists on leading the next team exam, feeling off her game.
23	Failing To Launch	7.0	8.0	9.0	24.0	69.6	23.3		Cody presents and gets hammered; Reed's allies redirect the room; Katiya's plan withers, Bertram is "killed" in exercise, she barges the opposing house—bad optics.
24	Friendly Fire	5.0	9.0	9.0	23.0	71.4	25.9		Reed's presentation wins; Cody's mild critique is spun as jealousy and he snaps publicly; Katiya loses to Aryn, is told she's below the line, and learns her family's already in Gaffesend.
25	A House Divided	1.0	9.0	9.0	19.0	66.0	34.1		Cody spirals home; Katiya waits on his couch; their mutual failures ignite a bitter fight—door slammed shut again.
26	Cold War	9.0	9.0	10.0	28.0	87.9	4.9		Jackson's "Operation Bluewings" flashback: drone crash, mission abort, and his sacrificial call to Overwatch in the storm.
27	Warm Solitude	5.0	9.0	10.0	24.0	78.6	14.1		Katiya's origin trauma: childhood game ? treehouse collapse ? Raph's death; she hides in a corpse pit; the Chymaeran lie brands her forever.

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28	Prometheus	6.0	7.0	8.0	21.0	66.7	38.2		Months later: Naveen notes Cody's improvement but deeper ennui; company lunch where Reed is promoted; Reed asks Cody to help fix his flawed prototype (they bond); that night Cody, riding the high, uses Essence as flux—batteries "fire" and spark his next idea.
29	Once Lovers	7.0	8.0	9.0	24.0	68.9	24.6		
30	Cold Sweat	1.0	7.0	8.0	16.0	43.6	50.4		
31	Heating Up	7.0	8.0	9.0	24.0	56.8	26.4		
32	Fantastic Modernity	2.0	5.0	5.0	12.0	25.5	85.6		
33	Modern Fantasy	4.0	7.0	8.0	19.0	48.9	46.1		
34	Professional Death	1.0	9.0	10.0	20.0	62.1	23.7		
35	Physical Demise	9.0	10.0	10.0	29.0	93.3	1.4		
36	Holding On	6.0	10.0	10.0	26.0	86.5	7.7		
37	Letting Go	1.0	10.0	10.0	21.0	70.1	21.4		
38	Bottoming Out	1.0	8.0	9.0	18.0	54.9	36.5		After reaching the ugliest versions of themselves, Cody and Katiya finally stop performing strength and let each other see the damage. Cody interrupts his own collapse long enough to comfort Katiya after Bertram's death, and Katiya's tribunal summons turns grief into a hard deadline. By the end of the chapter, despair has not lifted—but it has been given direction.

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39	Crossing Over	6.0	7.0	9.0	22.0	60.0	28.4		The private crisis inside Katiya's house becomes part of a much larger war when Titus and Sylvia force their way into the story. Cody is thrown into a terrifying first encounter with people from a harsher world, Katiya begins to understand the scale of what is coming, and Cody's attempt to regroup turns into a brutal training date that recommits him to fighting for a future instead of grieving one he already lost.
40	Reaching Up	2.0	6.0	8.0	16.0	44.2	49.6		The planning phase begins in earnest as Cody's world and Katiya's world stop operating like separate emotional shelters. Over coffee, cheap drinks, and overlapping stories, the group starts building a shared strategy. Cody's abandoned project stops being a joke, and Katiya's increasingly unstable home life collides with the possibility that her estranged allies might actually stand with her.
41	Annealment	6.0	7.0	9.0	22.0	57.8	28.4		Action replaces vague intention. Cody begins rebuilding JAX with help instead of shame, while Katiya tries to hold together a house full of secrets, fugitives, and divided loyalties. Both storylines harden under pressure: Cody through labor, Katiya through deception and risk.
42	Eutectic Point	1.0	7.0	9.0	17.0	45.4	38.9		The story widens. Katiya is introduced to Aliaki, Jade, and the deeper political reality behind the coming attack, while Cody is invited deeper into Reed's privileged world

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									and closer to a genuine second chance at proving himself. Both protagonists are handed tools and warnings they only partly understand.
43	Harsh Noise	1.0	8.0	9.0	18.0	47.7	37.1		Hope starts making noise. Cody begins fabrication in Reed's family machine space and gains the first meaningful encouragement he has felt from adults tied to the aerospace legacy he still wants. Meanwhile, Katiya's alliance nearly implodes in a misunderstanding fueled by power and distrust, forcing her to stabilize a group that could either save Gaffesend or tear itself apart.
44	In Loving Memory	1.0	8.0	9.0	18.0	48.2	36.7		Grief finally becomes communal instead of private. Cody helps Aryn and Rayna speak through loss by talking about Jackson, Katiya returns to a quieter house and finds evidence of the care he has extended to others, and the chapter ends with intimacy growing out of exhaustion, trust, and shared mourning.
45	In Future Grief	1.0	8.0	9.0	18.0	51.4	36.1		Both protagonists face family systems that love them but do not really understand what they are choosing. Cody confronts his parents' fear, finances, and assumptions about his future, while Katiya tells her family the truth about the danger she still intends to face. Jackson's name and memory become fused to Cody's project, turning invention into memorial.

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46	Close Quarters	1.0	10.0	10.0	21.0	59.6	20.6		The quiet before the storm turns out not to be quiet at all. Cody and Katiya field-test the prototype and accidentally unleash terrifying power, then return home to find official pressure closing around Katiya's life. Their last stretch of peace becomes a vow, a confession, and an act of choosing each other before the worlds move to tear them apart.
47	Ground Control	2.0	8.0	10.0	20.0	60.2	24.0		Cody and Katiya each step into what should be their final chance to claim the futures they want, only to be immediately restrained by the institutions they have spent the story trying to survive. Cody tries to reach the Aspen conference room before HR can bury him, while Katiya is taken into custody before her tribunal and shut away from the threat she knows is coming. By the end of the chapter, both are trapped inside systems that mistake control for safety.
48	Metanoia	2.0	7.0	8.0	17.0	58.1	47.0		Both protagonists fight for one clean chance to be heard. Cody's confession turns his firing into a political problem inside Navidson-Monroe, while Katiya persuades Aryn that the truth matters more than procedure and turns imprisonment into a joint push toward Aldrin. The chapter tests what they have actually learned: not how to escape pressure, but how to move through it without lying to themselves.
49	Paragate	9.0	9.0	10.0	28.0	91.8	5.2		The true conflict of Paragate begins as witness replaces doubt and preparation replaces denial.

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									Aldrin sees enough to gamble on Katiya, while Cody leaves Navidson-Monroe uncertain of what his honesty has bought him but sure he is not done yet. Both protagonists step fully into the roles they have been resisting, and the story pivots from argument into mobilization.
50	Knightfall	8.0	10.0	10.0	28.0	93.6	2.9		The battle turns when Cody is the first to notice movement across the frozen lake and realizes the defense is pointed the wrong way. As the first line is held by powers and allies beyond the core cast, the real threat reveals itself as a coordinated strike against the city itself. Katiya is forced into the exact shape of the nightmare that made her who she is, and Cody refuses to leave her to face it entirely alone.
51	Daybreak	10.0	10.0	10.0	30.0	93.4	1.1		Katiya confronts the living shape of her oldest trauma and proves that what she has learned is stronger than fear. As Nhytyx recreates the emotional architecture of the nightmare that once broke her, Katiya saves her family through action instead of paralysis, while Cody disobeys her only enough to make one small but crucial difference. At dawn, Katiya completes her arc not just by surviving the past, but by replacing it with a new public truth.
52	Parasmagate	1.0	6.0	7.0	14.0	45.5	64.8		The epilogue gives Paragate its emotional closure before leaving one quiet fracture open for the future. Cody and Katiya emerge from the battle changed, no

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									longer using each other's worlds as refuge from their own lives, and their relationship finally rests on chosen commitment instead of mutual escape.
53	Threaded Echoes	2.0	8.0	9.0	19.0	50.9	38.0		